UU-P-0016B(GSA-FSS)
August 6, 1970
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. UU-P-0016a(GSA-FSS)
July 13, 1966, and
INTERIM REVISION OF
Fed. Spec. UU-P-16
April 20, 1939

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PAD, DESK, BLOTTER

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification UU-P-16 dated April 20, 1939.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers two types of desk pads designed to hold blotters.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. The desk pads shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Paperboard back.
Type II - Deleted (see 6.3).
Type III - Linoleum back.
Type IV - Deleted (see 6.3).

1.2.2 Colors. (See 3.1.2 and 6.2 for type III only).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

L-P-378 - Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin.
UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping.
CCC-A-700 - Artificial Leather, Cloth, Coated, Vinyl Resin (Upholstery).
LLL-F-1238 - Floor Covering, Linoleum.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard; Corrugated and Solid Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Federal Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Publications:

T410 os-68 - Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T807 su-66 - Bursting Strength of Paperboard and Linerboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, New York, New York 10017.)

National Classification Board:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Attention: Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, 202 Union Street, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials. The materials used shall conform to the applicable specifications and requirements specified herein. When materials are not definitely specified, they shall be of the quality normally used for the purpose in commercial practice.

3.1.1 Paperboard (type I pad). Paperboard shall be stiff, hard, free from warp, not less than 0.115 inch in thickness, and shall have a basis weight of not less than 318 pounds per 1000 square feet. The paperboard shall have a minimum bursting strength of 230 points. (See 4.1.1.1.1).

3.1.2 Linoleum (type III pad). Linoleum shall conform to the requirements of LLL-F-1238, type I, class 1 or 2, grade B. The color shall be brown, green, or red, as specified (see 6.2).

3.1.3 Artificial leather.

3.1.3.1 Artificial leather for type I pads. The artificial leather for type I pads shall conform to the following physical requirements (see 4.1.1.1.2):

	Ounces per square yard (minimum)
Total weight of finished artificial leather	10
Weight of coating	4.5

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The base cloth shall be of cotton with a napped surface, and shall be free from sizing other than that present in the fabric as it comes from the mill. The coating shall not contain linseed oil, rubber, or rubber substitutes. The cloth shall be evenly and smoothly coated on the outside and shall be free from holes, cracks, or other defects, and free from objectionable odor. The finish shall be that of simulated top grain leather, smooth to the touch. The color shall be brown.

The coating of the artificial leather shall show no signs of cracking or flaking when tested as specified in 4.1.1.1.3.

3.1.3.2 Artificial leather for type III pads. The artificial leather for type III pads shall conform to the requirements of CCC-A-700, class 1, 2, or 7, with mildew resistant treatment. The color shall be that specified for the linoleum (see 3.1.2).

3.1.4 Facing sheets (type I pad). The facing sheets shall be of paper suitable for the purpose and of a dark color. A mottled or marbleized effect will be permitted.

3.1.5 Felt backing (type III pad). The felt shall be of a good grade, consisting of at least 25 percent wool content. The wool may be new, reprocessed, or reused. The thickness of the felt shall be in accordance with commercial practice. (See 4.1.1.2.1).

3.2 Design and Construction.

3.2.1 Type I pads. The type I pad shall consist of a paperboard back, two facing sheets, and four triangular corners.

3.2.1.1 Paperboard back. The back shall be of paperboard specified in 3.1.1. A facing sheet (see 3.1.4) shall neatly and securely cover the entire top of the paperboard, and overlap all edges for not less than 1/2 inch. The overlap shall be turned under and securely adhered to the bottom surface of the paperboard. After the corners have been attached, the bottom surface of the pad shall be covered with a facing sheet (see 3.1.4) to within not more than 1/8 inch from all edges.

3.2.1.2 Corners. Corners shall be artificial leather specified in 3.1.3.1. Each corner shall be triangle in shape and shall extend 4 ± 1/4 inches along each of the two right angle edges. Corners shall be suitably reinforced and stiffened but not padded on the underside. The reinforcing material shall not be visible. The corners shall be neatly and securely glued to the underside of the pad with a lap of not less than 1/2 inch. Corners shall be rounded and shall be constructed so that a desk blotter can be inserted between the corners and the paperboard back. Corners shall have a minimum adhesion strength of 70 pounds when tested in accordance with 4.3.3.1.

3.2.1.3 Size. The type I pad shall be 19-1/4 ± 1/8 inches by 24-1/4 ± 1/8 inches.

3.2.2 Type III pads. The type III pad shall consist of a linoleum back to which two panels extend the full width of the pad, one on each side, and each pad shall have a felt backing.

3.2.2.1 Linoleum back. The back shall be linoleum specified in 3.1.2. The exposed edges of the linoleum shall present a smooth and neat appearance, and corners shall be rounded.

3.2.2.2 Panels. Panels shall be artificial leather specified in 3.1.3.2. The panels shall be 4 ± 1/4 inches wide, and the panel length shall be the entire width of the pad. Panels shall be neatly and securely glued to the underside of the linoleum back for at least 1/2 inch along the outside edges and the entire width of the pad at the panel ends. Each panel shall be suitably reinforced and padded to give stiffness and a slight cushion effect to the upper surface of the panel. The pad shall be constructed so that a desk blotter can be inserted between the panels and the linoleum back. Panels shall have a minimum adhesion strength of 35 pounds when tested in accordance with 4.3.3.2.

3.2.2.3 Felt backing. Felt shall be as specified in 3.1.5 and shall cover the entire back of the pad except for a maximum distance of 1/8 inch from all edges. The felt shall be neatly and securely glued for a width of at least 2 inches along all edges of the felt. Excessive glue shall not accumulate on the outside edges of the felt, and glue shall not bleed through the felt.

3.2.2.4 Size. The type III pad shall be 24-1/4 ± 1/8 inches by 38-3/8 ± 1/4 inches.

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3.3 Workmanship. The pad edges shall be straight and smooth. Except for rounded corners, edges of adjacent sides and ends shall be at 90 degree angles. Pads shall lay flat when placed on a flat surface. The felt used on the bottom of the type III pad shall protect the surfaces on which desk pads are normally used. Pads shall be free from defects which affect appearance or which might impair serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Examination and testing of components and materials. The supplier is responsible for insuring that all components and materials used in fabricating desk pads were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications. Component testing shall be performed on the following materials received at one time, of the same type and color, manufactured by the same source and essentially under the same conditions, and identified as used in the production of the quantity of the end items. The supplier shall maintain records of components and material testing. These records shall be available to the authorized Government representative, and shall include the source, date of receipt, component material designation, date of test(s), test data, and quantity of material represented by the test report. Each component test report must be within the period of the contract, or within the time authorized in the contract for production of standby stock in advance of the ordering period. Unless otherwise specified, the sample size shall be the sample unit specified in the applicable test method, selected at random within the shipment.

4.1.1.1 Type I desk pads.

4.1.1.1.1 Paperboard. The basis weight and bursting strength of paperboard shall be determined as described in TAPPI Test Methods 410 os-68, and T807 su-66, respectively, (see 3.1.1).

4.1.1.1.2 Determination of total weight and coating weight of artificial leather. The total weight of artificial leather shall be determined in accordance with method 5041 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 (see 3.1.3.1). The same specimens shall then be used to determine the weight of the coating in accordance withthe following procedure:

Soak the back of the specimens with cyclohexanone or other suitable solvent to assist in stripping the coating from the cloth (flash coated materials may be totally immersed in a container of solvent prior to stripping). The cloth, as well as any loose fibers or yarns that may have been separated from the piece during stripping, shall be immersed in hot cyclohexanone (approximately 92° C. (180° F.)) for two to five hours, then thoroughly rinsed with methyl ethyl ketone, dried, and reweighed. The loss in weight of the specimen will indicate the weight of the coating (see 3.1.3.1).

4.1.1.1.3 Test for cracking, artificial leather. One specimen, 8- by 8-inches, shall be taken from each 100 linear yards of artificial leather. Each specimen shall be tested as follows: Crease the test specimen to form a crease parallel to the direction of the filling yarns of the base cloth. A 10 pound metal roller approximately 5-1/2 inches in diameter and 2 inches in width with a suitable handle shall be rolled one time over the coated cloth specimen while the specimen rests on a hard surface. It shall then be folded in the same position, but the opposite direction and the weight again applied. The specimen shall then be visually examined for cracking or flaking which, if evident, shall be cause for rejection (see 3.1.3.1).

4.1.1.2 Type III desk pads.

4.1.1.2. Wool fiber identification and wool content. The wool fiber identification and wool content shall be determined in accordance with methods 1100 and 2101, respectively, of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 (see 3.1.5).

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. A lot shall consist of all desk pads of the same type, class, and color offered for inspection at one time.

4.2.2 Sampling of end-item for visual defects. A random sample of desk pads shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one desk pad.

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4.2.3 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. For examination of interior packages the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, and selected at random just prior to the closing operation. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Closure defects shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end-item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for end-item tests. A random sample of desk pads shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2. The AQL shall not exceed 6.5 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one desk pad.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual examination of end-item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table I. Any sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

TABLE I. Classification of desk pad defects

Examine	Defect
Classification:	
Type	Not as required.
Color of type III	Not as required.
Materials:	
Paperboard	Not stiff, hard, and free from warp. Thickness not as specified.
Facing sheets	Not as specified in 3.1.4.
Type I pads:	
Back	Not of paperboard.
Facing sheets	Not as specified in 3.2.1.1.
Corners	Not triangular in shape. Dimensions not as specified. Not reinforced. Reinforcing material visible. Not of artificial leather. Not neatly and securely attached to paperboard. Lap not covered by facing sheet.
Type III pads:	
Linoleum back	Not as specified in 3.2.2.1.
Panels	Not as specified in 3.2.2.2.
Felt backing	Does not cover area as specified in 3.2.2.3. Not neatly and securely attached. Excessive glue around felt edges or bleeding through felt.
Type I and III pads:	Pads do not lay flat. Pad dimensions not as specified. Edges not smooth and straight. Defects which affect appearance or impair serviceability.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II.

TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and (interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of containers.

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4.3.3 End-item tests. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be subjected to the following end-item tests:

4.3.3.1 Type I desk pads - corner adhesion strength. The adhesion of the artificial leather to the paperboard back shall be determined as described in method 5100 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191. The test specimen shall be one entire corner of the pad and shall measure not less than 4 inches by 4 inches. Cut and remove the specimen from the pad. Cut artificial leather only, from center of inside dimension to the edge underneath the corner, forming two equal size triangular-shaped flaps. The face of each jaw of each clamp of the testing machine shall measure not less than 2 inches nor more than 3 inches in width by 1 inch in depth. One clamp shall grip the artificial leather at the center of the flap and parallel to the pad edge. The face of the clamp shall be not more than 1/2 inch from the edge of the paperboard. The other clamp shall grip the paperboard. Each clamp shall not grip the material held by the other clamp. The distance between the clamps shall be not less than 1 inch at the start of the test. The speed of the pulling clamp shall be 12 ± 1 inches per minute (see 3.2.1.2).

4.3.3.2 Type III desk pads - panel adhesion strength. The adhesion of the panels to the linoleum back shall be determined as described in method 5100 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191. The test specimen shall be a strip of pad 2-1/2 inches by the full width of the panel, including panel material and linoleum. Cut specimen perpendicular to the length of the panel and remove from pad. The face of each jaw of each clamp of the testing machine shall measure not less than 2 inches nor more than 3 inches by 1 inch in depth. One clamp shall grip the panel flap parallel to and not more than 1 inch from the linoleum edge. The other clamp shall grip the linoleum back. Each clamp shall not grip the material held by the other clamp. The distance between the clamps shall be not less than 2 inches at the start of the test. The speed of the pulling clamp shall be 12 ± 1 inches per minute (see 3.2.2.2).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I, paperboard pad. Type I pads do not require packaging.

5.1.1.2 Type III, linoleum pad. Each type III pad shall be provided with a sheet of non-test fiberboard 1/8 inch thick between the two full dimensions of the width and length of the pad inside the edges of the end panels. The pad shall be wrapped in 50 pound (24 X 36 = 500) basis weight kraft paper conforming to UU-P-268, grade B, or polyethylene film conforming to L-P-378, type I, grade A, finish 1, a minimum of 1.5 mils thick. The ends of the wrap shall be secured with tape not less than 2 inches wide applied over the entire width of the folded ends.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I, paperboard pad. Type I pads do not require packaging.

5.1.2.2 Type III, linoleum pad. The type III pads shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.2.

5.1.3 Level C. The pads shall be packaged to afford protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Type I, paperboard pad. Forty type I pads of like description shall be packed flat, single stacked, in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, style CSSC or FTC, class weather-resistant. The grade for the type CSSC box shall be 275 and grade 200 for the style FTC box. A sheet of corrugated fiberboard the full dimensions of the inside of the box shall be positioned on the top of the pads. The fiberboard shall meet the requirements of PPP-F-320, type CF, variety SW, grade 200. The box shall be closed, waterproofed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.1.2 Type III, linoleum pad. Ten type III pads of like description shall be packed flat, single stacked, in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, type CF, style CSSC or FTC, class weather-resistant. The grade for the style CSSC box shall be 275 and grade 200 for the style FTC box. The box shall be closed, waterproofed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

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5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Type I, paperboard pad. Forty type I pads of like description shall be packed flat, single stacked, in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, style CSSC or FTC, class domestic. The grade for the style CSSC box shall be 275 and grade 200 for the style FTC box. A sheet of corrugated fiberboard the full dimensions of the inside of the box shall be positioned on the top of the pads. The fiberboard shall meet the requirements of PPP-F-320, type CF, variety SW, grade 200. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2.2 Type III, linoleum pad. Ten type III pads of like description shall be packed flat, single stacked, in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, style CSSC or FTC, class domestic. The grade for the style CSSC box shall be 275 and grade 200 for the style FTC box. A sheet of corrugated fiberboard the full dimensions of the inside of the box shall be positioned on the top of the pads. The fiberboard shall meet the requirements of PPP-F-320, type CF, variety SW, grade 200. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The pads packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in containers to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agenices. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The type I pads are intended for general office use, and the type III pads for executive office use.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type of desk pad desired (see 1.2.1).
(c) Color for type III pads (see 1.2.2 and 3.1.2).
(d) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Former classification. Requirements for felt pads (type II) and molded rubber pads (type IV) have not been included in this specification.

GSA DC 77-8004

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GENERAL SERVICES ADMINISTRATION - FEDERAL SUPPLY SERVICE

SPECIFICATION COMMENT SHEET

BUDGET BUREAU NO. 29-R0175

INSTRUCTIONS

This form provides a way for users of this specification to inform the originator of problems encountered in its use. It is not to be used to request changes to accommodate proprietary features. All comments will be considered and appreciated, but please do not expect a reply. To comment: detach, complete, and mail to: Gen. Services Admin., FSS (FMSO), Washington, D.C. 20406

NOTE: Comments on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any part of the document or serve to amend contractual requirements.

1. SPECIFICATION

UU-P-0016B (GSA-FSS) - PAD, DESK, BLOTTER

2. CONTRACT NO. *(If any)*	3. QUANTITY ON CONTRACT *(Optional)*	4. DOLLAR VALUE *(Optional)*

5. GENERAL NATURE OF PROBLEM *(e.g., inspection difficulties, manufacturers unable to meet tolerances, containers collapse under normal warehousing conditions, etc.)*

6. SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS AFFECTED *(Include paragraph number and lines of wording)*

7. SPECIFIC PROBLEMS *(e.g. tests in 4.2.2 will not assure that the battery will last required time; temperature ranges in table 2 do not conform to commercially available items.)*

8. RECOMMENDATIONS

9. NAME OF MANUFACTURER, ASSOCIATION, GOVT., AGENCY, ETC.	10. ADDRESS *(Number, Street, City, State and Zip Code)*

11. NAME AND TITLE OF SUBMITTER	12. DATE

FORM GSA-FSS 83 2200

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